



MONTHLY UPDATE

Eritrea: monthly update, August – September 2026

Edition of 2026-09-10 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

Developments summarised from sources published between the beginning of last month and today.

SUMMARY OF THE MONTH · GOVERNANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · TECHNOLOGY · INCLUSION · DATA

Summary of the month

Ten rows move in the month, and several of them establish an absence rather than a system — which is the characteristic shape of this base. A legal-research pass dated 1 August [re-verified that no comprehensive data-protection law is in force, no supervisory authority exists and no enforcement decisions have been published](#). The postal union's August addressing reference [does not list Eritrea among the countries operating a postal-code system](#). Against those, three things exist: a water project [held geodesign workshops in Asmara with more than twenty government, academic, private-sector and non-governmental participants](#); the state telecommunications provider [runs a live web complaint form for internet faults](#); and the same provider [publishes a private cloud service hosted entirely in its own data centres](#), the first primary evidence on this base that provider-hosted storage exists in the country at all. A regional climate centre's advisory of 10 August [forecasts below-normal rainfall over western Eritrea from satellite-derived soil-moisture and vegetation-stress monitoring](#): the country is covered by monitoring produced abroad. The month's one piece of ordinary news is a software collective: on 15 August the information ministry [interviewed Shambko Apps Group, which has released five Tigrinya-language mobile applications](#) built to the national curriculum. Eritrean writing about Eritrea's own infrastructure still comes from the information ministry's outlet or a diaspora one: the month's [proposal for a cable landing, an exchange point at Asmara and a national digital infrastructure authority](#) came from the second, and carries no sign of government adoption.

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

The month adds the sector's policy furniture rather than a new instrument. A country profile lists the legal basis as [Communications Proclamation 102 of 1998, the Regulations on Telecommunications Networks and Services of the same year, and a 2003 proclamation establishing the state telecommunications corporation](#), none of which the base holds as text. The one sector-specific policy named anywhere is for education: an education profile last modified on 2 September records a [National Policy for ICT in Education, a 2018-2022 sector plan aiming at technology infrastructure and e-learning, and an initiative the ministry launched in January 2005](#), and the sector plan itself states that incorporating technology remains difficult for want of facilities, equipment and teacher training. The profile carrying it is a legacy platform its publisher states is no longer updated. No national digital or ICT strategy appears at any date, so the sector is governed by three texts from 1998 and 2003 that nobody on this base has read.

Data protection

The data-protection position was re-verified rather than changed. A legal-research pass dated 1 August 2026 [records no comprehensive data-protection law in force, no supervisory authority established and no enforcement decisions published](#). What the month adds is the date, not the finding: the absence is now a searched one rather than an unexamined one. It agrees with a regional ministerial assessment placing Eritrea's data-protection policy area at a nascent stage without legislation or regulatory oversight, and with a trade regulatory profile recording no data-protection officer, impact-assessment or retention requirements. Three independent assessments across four years say the same thing, which is what distinguishes a reported absence from an unexamined one.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

Outside consultation reached Asmara. A water-security project [held two rounds of geodesign workshops in July 2026 with more than twenty government, academic, private-sector and non-governmental participants, alongside a hydrological-modelling training session for Eritrean technical experts](#). It is the convener's own account of process, and it sits against a state the record elsewhere describes as silencing criticism systematically.

ICT Infrastructure

Data Storage

Domestic hosting appears on this base for the first time, and it is the state operator that put it there. Eritel [publishes a private cloud service hosted entirely in its own data centres, in three subscription tiers of 100, 250 and 500 gigabytes for 20, 50 and 100 users, each carrying a 90 per cent uptime service level and a recovery-time objective of up to six days](#). Those are subscription sizes rather than a statement of the estate behind them: no aggregate capacity figure, facility count or location is published for Eritrea by anyone, and a six-day recovery objective is the measure of what backup means in this market. Three weeks earlier a diaspora outlet [set out a national digital infrastructure agenda – a submarine cable landing at Massawa and Assab, redundant fibre, an exchange point at Asmara, domestic data-centre capacity, diversified technology partners and a national digital infrastructure authority](#). It is an independent publication rather than a think tank or a government document, and nothing records the adoption of any part of it.

DPI

Registries

The month establishes an absence rather than a system. The postal union's addressing reference, dated August 2026, [does not list Eritrea among the countries that require or use a postal-code system](#), so there is no national postcode scheme. Nothing on the record names another national addressing scheme, digital or otherwise. The reference does not itself say whether one is planned, and no street-naming programme, digital addressing initiative or geocoding of the population registers appears anywhere on the record. The registers themselves remain six separate regional systems with no central national register, so an address held in one is not resolvable from another.

Technology

Innovation ecosystem

On 15 August the Ministry of Information [interviewed Shambko Apps Group, a self-organised software collective that has released five Tigrinya-language mobile applications](#) — literacy, puzzle, cultural-heritage and arithmetic tools built to the national curriculum — and set out a plan to extend them to Eritrea's eight other national languages. It is the first non-state software effort the base holds for Eritrea. No download count, distribution channel or funding source is stated, and the account is the state broadcaster's own.

Inclusion

Access to services

One digital feedback channel is on the record, and it belongs to the operator rather than the state. The sole state telecommunications provider [runs a live web form for internet-connectivity, website-access and web-application complaints, with telephone and email alternatives](#). No whole-of-government complaint route is recorded, and no volume of complaints made or resolved is published.

Data

Use of satellite data

Eritrea is covered by satellite monitoring it does not produce. A regional climate centre's advisory of 10 August [uses precipitation index analysis with satellite-derived soil-moisture and vegetation-stress monitoring to raise its alert level and forecast below-normal rainfall over western Eritrea](#). It sits alongside a food agency dataset carrying [dekadal rainfall indicators computed from satellite precipitation imagery blended with station data and short-term forecasts, aggregated to subnational units and refreshed roughly every two weeks](#). Both are addressed to Eritrea; neither is made in it. Eritrea's own delegation to the desertification convention listed setting up a modern national meteorological service among its forward strategies, which places a modern service as an objective rather than an institution; what exists is split between a civil aviation meteorological service and an agricultural meteorology unit. The ministry staff trained this year in remote sensing and land-cover classification are the capacity that would one day read imagery, not a product built from it.

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